INTERNAL COVER NOTE — NOT PART OF THE PACKET. DO NOT SEND THIS SECTION TO ANY SCHOOL.

- **Status: FINAL.** The owner authorized launch on October 25, 2026, after the Legal Desk audit fixes were applied (audit: legal-desk-packet-launch-audit-2026-10-25.md — verdict READY AFTER FIXES; Defects 1–11 are addressed in this version, including the enclosures the audit requires: the model FERPA consent forms, the NH parental authorization form, the work-state instrument sheet, and the hours-limits card).
- **This version is for Education Across the States placements only.** A parallel FINAL packet exists for the other program; each student placement is with one program, and the packets are not combined.
- **Minimum student age: 16** — confirmed by the owner (Oct 25, 2026) for both programs; this supersedes the Legal Desk's recommended 14. Direct applications are accepted only from people 18 or older; high school placements run through schools only; the school obtains and transmits everything; no ID images in this channel; no transcripts, grades, attendance records, health records, or IEPs; application records are retained permanently.
- **Source model:** Legal Desk memo, *School-Certification Model for High School Opportunities: Does It Suffice?* (Oct 25, 2026) — verdict: **suffices with conditions**. The conditions are built into this packet.
- **Carried open items (not packet defects — unresolved at launch):** how NH DOL characterizes the work site for a fully remote placement under Lab 805 is UNVERIFIED; insurance for a non-employee student injured while doing our work is UNVERIFIED; the Q3 security facts (MFA on the show Google account, named access roster, no link-sharing, written information security program) are UNVERIFIED; there is no route under this packet for minors not enrolled in a participating school (homeschooled, gap-year); whether unpaid interns count toward Indiana's five-minor employer-registration threshold (Ind. Code § 22-2-18.1-26) is UNVERIFIED. New Jersey placements remain on hold, and the school-facing text says so.

School Partnership Packet — Education Across the States

High School Student Internship Placements

Professional Development Inc., doing business as **Education Across the States**

From: **Charles Mayfield, Producer**

Contact: educationacrossthestates@gmail.com · (978) 291-8525

The opportunity

Our podcast program — **Education Across the States** (education news and policy) — offers internship placements for high school students in media production and research: research and fact-checking support, interview preparation, production support, and show notes. The work is supervised and learning-structured; a producer reviews everything before anything airs or is published.

Placements for high school students run **only through schools**, as an approved extended learning opportunity (ELO) or work-based learning placement under the school's own policy:

- **One school semester/term**, on a schedule the school approves.
- **Educational and unpaid** — a practical-experience placement, not a job.
- **Producer-supervised** on our side. The school's certified educator of record remains the school-side supervisor; grading and credit are the school's.
- **Students must be at least 16 years old.**
- We accept direct applications only from people **18 or older**. There is no direct application for high school students — if a student asks us directly, we will point them to your office.

New Jersey placements are not being accepted at this time. If your student is in New Jersey, please do not submit a packet; we will notify schools when this changes.

What we require from the school before a student starts

We give you the requirements; **your school obtains them and transmits them to us**. Nothing is collected from the student or the family by us directly — the school submits the student's application materials, the signed certification below, and the instruments as the work-state instrument sheet (Enclosure C) specifies.

1. **The signed certification (below)** — one per student, signed and dated by your school's **ELO coordinator, or an administrator authorized to certify school records disclosures**. Your guidance/counselor's office is our contact and routing point for everything.

2. **Parental consent to disclose (FERPA).** Your school holds a written consent, **signed and dated** by the parent or legal guardian — or by the student, if the student is 18 or older — that meets 34 CFR § 99.30: it specifies the records disclosed (the student's application materials: name, contact information for program communications, school and grade, the student's statement of interest and any work samples prepared for the application, together with this certification and the instrument copies listed in it), states the purpose (consideration for and administration of an unpaid educational internship placement), and names **Professional Development Inc., doing business as Education Across the States**, as the

recipient. **The original stays with your school**; the certification attests to it by date, and you produce a copy if we ask. (A consent that meets § 99.30 must be written — oral permission does not qualify.) A model consent form carrying these elements is enclosed for your file (Enclosure A — parent/guardian and eligible-student variants); your own form is equally acceptable if it carries the same elements.

3. **Parental permission for the placement itself.** Signed written permission from the parent or legal guardian for the student to take part in this unpaid placement.

- **New Hampshire:** this is the written parental authorization described in **NH Lab 1002.02** — it states our establishment name and location, the date permission is given, the parent/guardian signature, the position title or description of work activities, and the student's date of birth. **A copy goes to us and must be in our file before the student's first day.** A one-page form carrying all five elements is enclosed (Enclosure B).

4. **Youth-work instruments for the work state, attached as the work-state instrument sheet specifies.** Paperwork follows **where the student will physically perform the work** — say so on the certification, especially if the student attends school in one state and will work from another. For that work state, either:

- attach the instrument or a copy, as the work-state instrument sheet specifies, identified by type and date on the certification; or
- state the **specific exemption** relied on, with its citation.

A general statement that "all requirements have been met" is not enough — we hold in the student's file the instrument or copy the sheet specifies.

5. **New Hampshire placements — Lab 805 approval.** Where the work state is New Hampshire, the placement must be covered **before it starts** by an approval under **RSA 279:22-aa / NH Lab 805** naming our work site. Your school may file that application (the rules expressly allow the school to apply); we will supply our work-site information for it — legal name, federal ID number, work-site address, and New Hampshire employee count — on request. When the approval issues, **send us our copy of the signed approval form** for the student's file. We do not accept students under 16 in this channel. No under-16 placement will be certified or started under this packet.

6. **The schedule.** The student's planned days and hours, within the work state's hours limits for a student of that age. The enclosed hours-limits card (Enclosure D) is completed for the student's work state at intake, so the school, the student, and we all schedule from the same numbers.

7. **Age, verified by the school.** The student is at least **16**. Your school verifies age through its own records. **Do not send us a copy of the student's ID — we neither request nor accept ID images in this channel.**

8. **Nothing extra.** Do **not** include a transcript, grades, attendance record, health record, or IEP. We will not ask for them; if we ever need anything beyond this packet, we will request it through your school.

9. **Tell us if anything changes.** Please notify us promptly if a consent or permission is withdrawn, the student leaves the school or the placement, or the school's approval of the placement changes.

10. **Steps that are ours.** In a small number of states, a registration or application step sits with us as the placement organization rather than with the school, and some instruments must carry our signature. Where that applies, we complete our step ourselves — and sign what must be signed — before the start, and confirm to you; your certification does not have to cover it. The work-state instrument sheet (Enclosure C) identifies these state by state. Before any start, we confirm with you that the work state's checklist is complete.

The start gate

Nothing begins until the student's file is complete, and we confirm completeness to your school in writing. A complete file is:

- the school's submission of the student's application materials;
- the **signed certification** below; and
- **copies of the required instruments** (or the cited exemption) — including, for every New Hampshire work-state placement, the Lab 1002.02 parental document copy and the Lab 805 approval naming our work site. If the Lab 805 application is still in process, the file is not complete and the student does not start.

If anything is pending — for example, a Lab 805 application still in process — the student does not start until it issues and reaches our file. Only after we confirm the file is complete do we set a start date with your school.

School certification

School letterhead. One per student. Signed original returned to us; we keep it permanently with the student's application record.

> **SCHOOL CERTIFICATION — STUDENT INTERNSHIP PLACEMENT PACKET**
>
> **To:** Professional Development Inc., doing business as **Education Across the States** ("the Program")

Student: _____ Date of birth: _____ Grade: _____

School / District: _____

State where the student will physically perform the placement work: _____

The undersigned school official certifies, on behalf of the school named above, each of the following:

1. **Enrollment and program.** The student is enrolled at this school, and the placement is made under the school's board-adopted extended learning opportunity / work-based learning policy, with an individual learning plan approved in advance by the school. The certified educator of record / program coordinator for this placement is: _____ (name, title, school email, phone).

2. **Age.** The student's date of birth is as stated above. The student meets the Program's minimum age (16).

3. **Parental consent to disclose (FERPA).** The school holds a written consent, signed and dated by the student's parent or legal guardian — or by the student, if the student is 18 or older — that satisfies 34 CFR § 99.30: it specifies the records disclosed (the student's application materials: name, contact information for program communications, school and grade, the student's statement of interest and any work samples prepared for the application, together with this certification and the instrument copies listed in it), states the purpose (consideration for and administration of an unpaid educational internship placement), and identifies Professional Development Inc., doing business as **Education Across the States**, as the recipient. Date of consent: _____. The school will produce a copy on the Program's request and will notify the Program promptly if the consent is withdrawn.

4. **Parental permission for the placement.** The parent or legal guardian has given signed written permission for the student to participate in this unpaid placement, as required by the law of the work state identified above (in New Hampshire, the written parental authorization described in NH Lab 1002.02). A copy is attached for the Program's file.

5. **Youth-work instruments.** Each certificate, permit, registration, or approval required by the law of the work state for this placement has been obtained before submission. Instruments are identified here and copies are attached: _____. If any instrument is claimed not to be required, the exemption relied on is identified here with its citation: _____.

6. **New Hampshire placements (complete if the work state is New Hampshire).** The placement is covered by an approval under RSA 279:22-aa / NH Lab 805 naming the Program's work site (approval/form number: _____; approval date: _____; work site(s) covered: _____). A copy of the signed approval form is attached.

7. **Schedule.** The student's planned schedule for this placement is _____ (days/hours), which is within the hours limits of the work state for a student of this age.

8. **What is not included.** This packet contains no transcript, grades, attendance record, health record, or individualized education program (IEP). If the Program needs anything beyond this packet, it will request it through the school.

9. **Continuing duty.** The school will notify the Program promptly if the student withdraws from the placement or the school, if any consent or permission described above is withdrawn, or if the school's approval of the placement changes.

Signed: _____ **Date:** _____

Name / Title: _____ (ELO Coordinator, or administrator authorized to certify school records disclosures)

Guidance / counselor's office contact: _____ (name, email, phone)

Parent/guardian privacy notice

Please give this notice to the student's parent or guardian. It explains what the school sends us and what we do with it.

Your student's internship application — what we receive and how we keep it

Your student's school is submitting an application for an unpaid educational internship placement with **Professional Development Inc.**, doing business as **Education Across the States** (producer: Charles Mayfield), as part of the school's extended learning opportunity or work-based learning program. You gave your school written permission for this. Here is what that means on our side:

What the school sends us

- Your student's application materials: name, contact information for program communications, school and grade, and the student's statement of interest and any work samples prepared for the application.
- The school's signed certification that the placement requirements are met and that your written permission is on file.
- Copies of the youth-work paperwork for the placement (for example, a work certificate or permit, the signed parental permission document, and, in New Hampshire, the state placement approval).

What we do not receive

- **No ID image.** We do not request, receive, or keep a copy of your student's state ID. The school verifies age.
- No transcript, grades, attendance record, health record, or IEP.

How we use and keep it

- We use this information **only** to consider and administer your student's placement. We do not sell it, and we do not share it outside the placement.
- We keep application records **permanently** as program records — the application, the school's certification, and the paperwork copies above are our record of the placement and of how your student's eligibility and your permission were verified.
- Questions, corrections, or concerns: contact Charles Mayfield, Producer, at **educationacrossthestates@gmail.com**, or (978) 291-8525.

Enclosures

This packet includes four enclosures: **Enclosure A** — model FERPA consent forms (for the school's file); **Enclosure B** — New Hampshire parental authorization form; **Enclosure C** — work-state instrument sheet; **Enclosure D** — hours-limits card.

Enclosure A — Model consent to disclose education records (FERPA, 34 CFR § 99.30)

For the school's file. Use the variant that fits the signer: a parent or legal guardian signs for a student under 18; a student who is 18 or older — an eligible student, to whom FERPA rights have transferred — signs for themselves. A school may use its own form instead, provided it carries the same elements: signature and date, the records specified, the purpose stated, and the recipient identified.

Variant 1 — Parent or legal guardian

CONSENT TO DISCLOSE EDUCATION RECORDS

Student: _____ School / District: _____

I am the parent or legal guardian of the student named above. I give my written consent for the school named above to disclose the records specified below to the recipient named below, for the purpose stated below.

Records that may be disclosed: the student's application materials: name, contact information for program communications, school and grade, the student's statement of interest and any work samples prepared for the application, together with this certification and the instrument copies listed in it.

No other records are covered by this consent — in particular, no transcript, grades, attendance record, health record, or individualized education program (IEP).

Purpose of the disclosure: consideration for and administration of an unpaid educational internship placement.

Recipient: Professional Development Inc., doing business as **Education Across the States**.

Parent/guardian signature: _____ Printed name: _____

Date signed: _____

The signed original of this consent stays at the school; the school attests to it by date in its certification and produces a copy on the Program's request.

Variant 2 — Eligible student (18 or older)

CONSENT TO DISCLOSE EDUCATION RECORDS — ELIGIBLE STUDENT

Student: _____ School / District: _____

I am the student named above, and I am 18 or older. FERPA rights have transferred to me as an eligible student, and I give my written consent, on my own behalf, for the school named above to disclose the records specified below to the recipient named below, for the purpose stated below.

Records that may be disclosed: the student's application materials: name, contact information for program communications, school and grade, the student's statement of interest and any work samples prepared for the application, together with this certification and the instrument copies listed in it.

No other records are covered by this consent — in particular, no transcript, grades, attendance record, health record, or individualized education program (IEP).

Purpose of the disclosure: consideration for and administration of an unpaid educational internship placement.

Recipient: Professional Development Inc., doing business as **Education Across the States**.

Student signature: _____ Printed name: _____

Date signed: _____

The signed original of this consent stays at the school; the school attests to it by date in its certification and produces a copy on the Program's request.

Enclosure B — Parental authorization, New Hampshire (NH Lab 1002.02)

One page, one per student. The parent or guardian completes it; the school sends the completed copy to Professional Development Inc., and the copy must be in the Program's file before the student's first day.

PARENTAL AUTHORIZATION — UNPAID INTERNSHIP PLACEMENT (NEW HAMPSHIRE)

1. Establishment name and location: Professional Development Inc., doing business as Education Across the States, 7 Glen Road, Salem, New Hampshire 03079.

2. Student: _____ **Student's date of birth:** _____

3. Position title or description of work activities: Internship placement (unpaid, for practical experience) — research and fact-checking support, interview preparation, production support, and show notes, under producer supervision. Position title (if the school uses one): _____

4. Permission: I am the parent or legal guardian of the student named above, and I give permission for my student to take part in this unpaid placement with the establishment named above.

5. Parent/guardian signature: _____ **Printed name:** _____

Date permission is given: _____

Return the completed form to the school. The school sends a copy to Professional Development Inc. before the student's first day.

Enclosure C — Work-state instrument sheet

*Completed for the student's work state at intake. For each work state below, this sheet states what must issue before the student starts, whether the Program holds the original or a copy, and any instrument the Program must sign. **An instrument that requires the Program's signature is routed to the Program for signature before the start.***

- **New Hampshire.** Must issue before start: (1) the approval under RSA 279:22-aa / NH Lab 805 naming the Program's work site; and (2) the signed written parental authorization under NH Lab 1002.02 (Enclosure B). Custody: the Program holds a **copy** of the signed approval form — the Department returns the signed form to the applicant, who provides each participating work site with a copy for their file (Lab 805.05(c)) — and a **copy** of the signed parental authorization, both in the student's file before the student starts. Program signature: none on these instruments; the Program supplies its work-site information (legal name, federal ID number, work-site address, New Hampshire employee count) into the Lab 805 application on request.

- **New York.** The employment certificate issues through the school's certificating officer, but the **employer files the certificate at the place of the student's employment before work begins** (NY Labor Law § 135(1)(a)) and returns it when the placement ends — the employer, not the school, is responsible — so the Program holds the certificate itself during the placement, not a copy. The pledge of employment (NY Educ. Law § 3221) is **signed by the Program** as prospective employer: route it to the Program for signature before the start.
- **California.** The permit issues from the district as a Permit **to Employ** naming the employer (CA Educ. Code § 49113). The Program receives and holds the permit (original or copy, as the issuing district specifies) before the student starts.
- **Massachusetts.** The permit issues from the superintendent (MA Gen. Laws ch. 149, §§ 86–87). The § 87 pledge is **signed by the parent and by the employer**: route the pledge to the Program for signature before the start. The Program holds the permit (original or copy, as the state specifies) before the student starts.
- **School-issued, employer-held states — Alabama, Connecticut, Delaware, District of Columbia, Louisiana, Maryland, Michigan, North Carolina, Pennsylvania, Puerto Rico, Washington, Wisconsin.** Certificates and permits issue through the school; the Program must receive and hold the certificate or permit (original or copy, as the state specifies) before the student starts, and sign any instrument the state's regime requires the employer to sign (routed to the Program for signature before the start).
- **Indiana — employer registration (the Program's own duty; no school step performs it).** Under Ind. Code § 22-2-18.1-26, an employer that hires, employs, or permits at least five (5) minors must register with the Indiana Department of Labor through the Youth Employment System (YES). If the threshold is met, the Program registers itself. **Whether unpaid interns count toward the five-minor threshold is UNVERIFIED.**
- **Oregon — annual employer application (the Program's own duty; no school step performs it).** The employer must apply for annual employment certificates to employ 14–17-year-olds. The Program files its own application annually.
- **No-certificate / proof-of-age states (including Arizona, Arkansas, Idaho, South Dakota).** No certificate or permit issues. The school's certification of the student's age eligibility, plus the Program's verification record, suffices; there is no instrument to hold.
- **New Jersey — DO NOT SUBMIT.** New Jersey placements are not being accepted at this time. Do not submit a packet for a New Jersey student; the Program will notify schools when this changes.
- **Any other work state or territory.** Completed for the student's work state at intake from the Program's checklist.

Enclosure D — Hours-limits card

Completed for the student's work state at intake. The school, the student, and the Program schedule from the same numbers; the planned schedule certified in the packet must sit within these limits.

HOURS-LIMITS CARD

Work state: _____ Student age: _____ Completed by: _____ Date: _____

New Hampshire (printed — RSA 276-A:4 VI, VII), for students 16 or 17 years old, duly enrolled:

• Maximum **35 hours** in a 5-day school week.

• Maximum **6 consecutive days** in a week.

• Maximum **48 hours** in vacation weeks.

Any other work state (complete at intake from that state's limits for a student of this age):

• School-week maximum: _____ hours

• Vacation-week maximum: _____ hours

• Consecutive-day limit: _____

• Other limits (daily hours, night hours): _____